DO YOU KNOW?

The **Westerlies or Anti-trades** are prevailing winds from the west toward the east in the middle latitudes between 30° and 60° latitude.

Natural Vegetation

North America is endowed with a diverse and extensive forest cover. Approximately 30 percentage of the total land area is under forest cover. Lumbering is a well developed industry particularly in Canada. North America is a major producer of timber, plywood, wood pulp and paper. It accounts for approximately 20 percent of the world's production of timber. This diversity is brought about primarily because of the different latitudes and variations in altitude, soil and precipitation.

Forest, Flora and Fauna of different regions of North America

S. No.	Types of forest	Climate	Region	Flora	Fauna
1	Tundra 	winter is long and severely cold, Summer is short and cool. Rainfall is scanty.	northern coast of Canada and Northern Islands	Mosses, lichens and Dwarf willows	Arctic Fox, Reindeer, Musk Ox, Polar Bears, Wolverin, Sable and Blue Fox
2	Taiga or the Cold temperate Coniferous Forest 	winter is very cold, Summer is warm and short. Heavy snowfall during winter	south central Alaska and north eastern Canada	Pine, Fir, Cedar and Spruce	Beaver, Fox, Sable, Ermine, Skunk, Caribou Moose, Elk, Black Bears and Grizzly Bears.
3.	Temperate Prairie Grasslands 	winter is very cold, Summer is hot and rainfall is moderate.	central USA and Central Canada	Grasses shrubs, herbs	Coyote, Gophers, Rabbits, Prairie Dogs and Bison
4.	The Mediterranean type 	hot summer and, cool winter.	western Coastal margin and Southern California	Olive, Grapes Orange, Cork, Oak, Walnut and Fig	Not much wildlife is found here

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